

About the National Heritage Council of South Africa (the NHC)

The National Heritage Council of South Africa is a government institution that is responsible for the preservation of the country's heritage. The important areas that the NHC focuses on are policy development for the sector to meet its transformation goals, public awareness and education, knowledge production in heritage subjects that were previously neglected, as well as making funding available to projects that place heritage as a socio-economic resource.

The National Heritage Council, a Schedule 3A public entity that came into existence through an amendment of the Cultural Laws Second Amendment Act 69 of 2001, was officially constituted through the National Heritage Council Act 11 of 1999, assented to on 14 April, 1999 and officially proclaimed on 26 February, 2004.

Our **vision** is to build a nation proud of its African heritage.

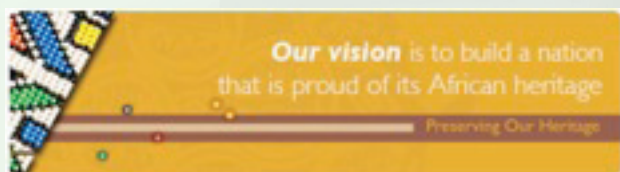
Our **mission** is to transform, protect and promote South African heritage for sustainable development.

Functions

The following are the functions of the Council that are derived from the NHC Act of 1999:

- a) advise the Minister on -
 - i. national policies on heritage matters, including indigenous knowledge systems, living treasures, restitution and other relevant matters, and;
 - ii. any other matter concerning the heritage which Minister may from time to time determine.
- b) advise the minister on the allocation of core funding to the declared cultural institutions;

- c) investigate ways and means of affecting the repatriation of South African heritage objects presently being held by foreign governments, public and private institutions and individuals;
- d) make grants to any person, organisation or institution in order to promote and develop national heritage activities and resources;
- e) coordinate activities of public institutions involved in heritage management in an integrated manner to ensure optimum use of State resources;
- f) monitor and coordinate the transformation of the heritage sector, with special emphasis on the development of living heritage projects;
- g) consult and liaise with relevant stakeholders on heritage matters;
- h) generally support, nurture and develop access to institutions and programmes that promote and bring equity to heritage management.
- i) promote awareness of the history of all our peoples, including the history of enslavement in South Africa;
- j) lobby in order to secure funding for heritage management and to create a greater public awareness of the importance of our nation's heritage
- k) perform such duties in respect of its objects as the Minister may assign to it.



'Building a Nation proud of its African heritage'

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